

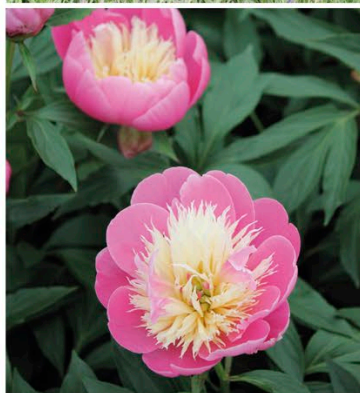
APPEALING TO THE SENSES

Plants with scented leaves and flowers are prized because they introduce a sensory quality that can lift the spirits at all times of the year. The perfume from a mahonia or witch hazel in the depths of winter is tempting enough to venture outside for, while the scent of honeysuckle is reason enough to spend summer evenings relaxing next to it. You will find a wealth of fragrant plants of all types outlined on pp.340–345.

You can also add a designer element to your garden by using plants that have different shapes, foliage color, and textures. Such plants also provide a permanent decorative framework for the more transitory elements.

The final section of the book focuses on problem areas, such as sun-baked sites, slopes, and waterlogged areas, as well as recommends plants to choose for gardens where pests are a nuisance. This section also offers low-maintenance solutions for large areas by offering a selection of weed-suppressing ground cover plants.

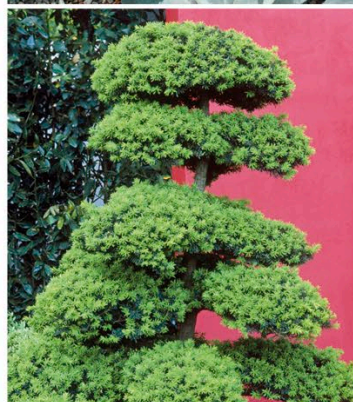
COLOR AND SCENT



Sensory pleasure Plants that produce colorful or sweetly scented flowers or leaves, such as lavender (*above*), form a key element of the sensory experience you can enjoy in your garden.

Choice plants Some plants, such as peonies (*left*), have exquisite, but short-lived blooms. Position them with other plants that provide longer-lasting color.

SHAPE AND TEXTURE



Enduring appeal Plants with bold stem and leaf structures and textures, such as the silvery mulleins *above*, will sustain interest over a longer period than plants with transient flower forms.

Creating shapes Many plants are ideal for training, shaping, or using as topiary (*left*), allowing you to create enduring dramatic and artistic effects in your garden.

PROBLEM SOLVING



Plant allies Ground-cover plants, such as lungwort (*above*) and leafy cranesbills, are perfect for suppressing unwanted weeds in shady areas.